

Among married individuals, prevalence rates for high blood pressure (14.2%) and diabetes (12.7%) remain at a high level. Analysis shows that prevalence rates are approximately similar for divorced and separated individuals, with diabetes ranging between 10.1 percent and 10.6 percent, while high blood pressure between 11.6 percent and 12.4 percent.

Prevalence Rates of Non-Communicable Diseases by Ethnic Group

The prevalence rates of NCDs by various ethnic groups are analyzed below. According to Table 6.3.10, the highest prevalence rates of non-communicable diseases are reported among the Malay and Burgher communities. Specifically, among the Malay community high blood pressure (13.8%), diabetes (11.5%), and high cholesterol (10.4%) all show higher rates than the national average in Sri Lanka. High prevalence rates for high blood pressure (12.2%), diabetes (10.7%), and high cholesterol (10.0%) were also reported among the Burgher community.

Table 6.3.10 : Prevalence Rates of Non-Communicable Diseases by Ethnic Group, 2024

Ethnic group	Total Population	Diabetes	High Cholesterol	High Blood Pressure	Heart Disease	Kidney Disease	Thalassemia	Cancer	Stroke	Asthma	Epilepsy
Sri Lanka*	21,779,483	8.5	8.2	10.1	2.5	0.8	0.1	0.4	0.6	1.8	0.3
Sinhala	16,142,478	8.6	8.7	10.5	2.6	0.8	0.1	0.4	0.6	1.7	0.3
Sri Lanka Tamil	2,681,263	8.0	7.2	8.8	2.1	0.7	0.1	0.3	0.6	3.0	0.4
Indian Tamil/Malaiyaga Thamilar	600,245	4.6	3.5	8.5	2.4	0.5	0.1	0.3	0.9	2.4	0.6
Sri Lanka Moor/ Muslim	2,283,055	9.2	7.7	9.3	2.1	0.5	0.1	0.2	0.4	1.7	0.3
Burgher	31,717	10.7	10.0	12.2	3.1	0.6	0.1	0.5	0.6	1.9	0.2
Malay	26,649	11.5	10.4	13.8	3.0	0.7	0.1	0.4	0.5	1.7	0.3
Sri Lanka Chetty	2,441	7.8	9.5	10.5	2.1	0.6	0.1	0.3	0.7	1.5	0.3
Bharatha	1,178	9.6	8.9	10.4	2.4	0.4	-	0.2	0.7	1.2	0.1
Veddas	1,372	6.3	4.1	5.3	1.4	2.0	0.7	0.3	1.2	2.6	0.5
Other	9,085	5.7	4.6	6.2	1.7	0.4	0.0	0.3	0.3	0.9	0.1

*Excluding the roofless population

Prevalence rates among the Sinhalese population are reported to be consistent with the national average of Sri Lanka. Among the Sri Lanka Moor population, the prevalence rate of diabetes (9.2%) is slightly higher than the national average. Within the Sri Lanka Tamil community, the prevalence rate of asthma (3.0%) is significantly higher than the national average (1.8%) of Sri Lanka. In contrast, the Indian Tamil/Malaiyaga Thamilar population reports noticeably lower prevalence rates for diabetes (4.6%) and high cholesterol (3.5%) compared to other ethnic groups.

High prevalence rates for asthma (2.6%), kidney disease (2.0%), stroke (1.2%), and thalassemia (0.7%) are reported among the Veddas community. These figures are higher than those of all other major ethnic groups.